

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·



① **considerable** [kən'sɪdərəbəl] *a.* 相当大的

② **assurance** [ə'ʃʊərəns] *n.* 保证

③ **descendant** [dɪ'sendənt] *n.* 后裔; 子孙

● 经典搭配

① take a ... view (采取……的视角)

② a surprising amount (惊人的数量)

③ identify a pattern (识别出一种模式)

④ shape the history of... (塑造……的历史)

⑤ make forecast (做出预测)

As so often, the past holds the key to the future; we have now identified enough of the long-term patterns shaping the history of the planet, and our species, to make evidence-based forecasts about the situations in which our descendants will find themselves.

分句1 主干:

As so often,	the past	holds	the key to the future
(状语)	主语	谓语	宾语

分句2 主干:

we	have now identified	enough of the long-term patterns
主语	谓语	宾语

现在分词后置定语:

shaping the history of the planet

插入语:

and our species

不定式目的状语:

to make evidence-based forecasts about the situations

定语从句:

in which	our descendants	will find	themselves
“介词+引导词”做状语	主语	谓语	宾语

功能注释:冒号后内容(分句2)对分句1进行说明,解释为什么过去掌握着通向未来的钥匙;分句2主干为 we have now identified enough of...;其中 the history of...呼应分句中 the past;插入成分 and our species 起到附带说明的作用,它与 the planet 在语法层面为并列关系,但从语义逻辑上来说并非论述重点;to make evidence-based...说明主句结果;in which 定语从句修饰 the situations,说明预测的具体内容。

· 语篇分析 ·



第六段进而阐释“以长远视角审视未来”的可行性及意义。关键词为:① a longer view;② considerable assurance.

①句承接上文,明确“思考未来”可行的方式:把目光放远。连词 and 起到“引出逻辑结果”的作用:看得远,则……。surprising amount 和 considerable assurance (considerable 指“相当大的,尤指大到足以产生某种影响的程度”)与上段“复杂多变、难以预测(many possibilities)”的特点形成对比,凸显观点“长远未来更易把握”。注意 say 为特殊用法,指“对未来可能情况的假定”。

②句具体阐述如何以长远视角思考未来。冒号前概括论点:应基于过去、鉴往知来。As so often 用于引出普遍适用、已得到实践确认的观点。the past holds the key to the future 充分肯定“研究历史”对于“预测未来”的关键作用。

冒号后解释“鉴往知来”为何可行。we have now identified... (identify 指 to recognize sth or discover exactly what it is“确定”)表明当前的有利条件;而既然掌握了足够的地球以及物种的重复及规律性发展模式(pattern 指 the repeated or regular way in which sth happens or is done),“知来”便顺理成章。long-term、enough、evidence-based 强调当前探索已有充分的科学依据,反衬“盲目幻想(vision、envisage)、想当然设想(assume)”下的非理性态度——极度悲观/乐观。注:句末 find themselves (in the situation) 字面意为“(子孙后代)发现自己的状态/所处境地”,修饰 the situation,故 the situation... 实际上诙谐表达“未来”之意。